The Ballad of George Zimmerman

By Dan O'Brien with music by Quetzal Flores

CHARACTERS:

- ***ZIMMERMAN*** *- Late 20s, would call himself Hispanic.*
- ***TRAYVON*** *- Late teens, would call himself Black.*
- ***OFFICER*** *- Would call herself White.*

TIME & PLACE:

Most takes place in the rain in a backyard at the Retreat at Twin Lakes in Sanford, Florida, February 26, 2012, a little after 7 p.m.- in the ten minutes or so from George Zimmerman's 911 call until Trayvon Martin's death.

ZIMMERMAN: *(On the phone with 911)* Hello? Hello?

We've had a few break-ins in the neighborhood,

and here comes this guy looking like he's up to no good.

Looking like he's on drugs or whatever.

It's pouring rain and he's just walking round.

What race is he? - Black.

What's he wearing? A hoodie

and blue jeans, white tennis shoes.

INTRODUCTION

ACTOR 1: *On February 26, 2012, Trayvon Martin, a Black teen walking home from a convenience store, is shot and killed by George Zimmerman, a neighborhood watch volunteer patrolling a townhouse community of Sanford, Florida.*

ACTOR 2: *Martin was just a teenager on the phone with a girl, carrying a bag of Skittles and an iced tea. But he was viewed by Zimmerman, whose father was white and whose mother was Hispanic, as scary, out of place, on drugs – someone who needs to be confronted, interrogated and put in his place.*

ACTOR 1: *This selection explores the mind of Trayvon Martin's killer . . .*

TOGETHER: *The Ballad of George Zimmerman by Dan O'Brien with music by Quetzal Flores*

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ZIMMERMAN: He's staring at me, at all the houses.

Why's he staring at me? Where am I?

Retreat, Retreat, Retreat, Retreat at Twin Lakes . . .

Retreat, Retreat at Twin Lakes . . .

He's coming towards me with his hand in his waistband.

He's a black guy for sure.

There's definitely something wrong with him.

He's coming back to check me out again with something in his hands.

How long till you get here?

Because these a**holes always get away.

- Now he's running.

Which way's he running?

I'm running after him.

I don't need to do that.

What's my name? George.

Last name Zimmerman.

I don't know where this kid's gone.

Hello? Hello? *(ends phone call)*

TRAYVON: Why you running after me?

ZIMMERMAN: Why are you here?

TRAYVON: I can't be?

ZIMMERMAN: Why aren't you running in out of the rain?

TRAYVON: I got this hoodie to keep me dry.

ZIMMERMAN: Let me see your face.

TRAYVON: Why?

ZIMMERMAN: You can see mine.

TRAYVON: Barely, barely.

ZIMMERMAN: What's that in your hand?

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TRAYVON: Show me yours and I'll show you mine.

ZIMMERMAN: Punks have been stealing.

TRAYVON: What punks?

ZIMMERMAN: Black punks that look like you. It's a fact.

TRAYVON: It's a fact you look like a skinhead, or a pervert of some kind. - That earring, man!

ZIMMERMAN: I'm married, man.

TRAYVON: Not for long.

ZIMMERMAN: If it were light you'd see my face. I'm Hispanic.
My mother is Peruvian. Her mother was half-black like you.

TRAYVON: I'm all black, ***ese***.

ZIMMERMAN: ***Mi abuela*** watching Sabado Gigante, cooking Papa ***a la Huancaina***.

TRAYVON: *What* is that?

ZIMMERMAN: Potatoes in cream sauce . . . Mmm . . .
I've protested police brutality against the homeless black guys.
I took a black girl to the prom.
I voted for Obama!
Obama, Obama, 'bama, Obama,
Obama, 'bama, Obama, Obama,
'bama, Obama, Obama, 'bama . . .

TRAYVON: Why you acting white then, Zimmerman?

ZIMMERMAN: How do you know my name?

TRAYVON: Is Zimmerman a Jewish name?
Zimmerman, Zimmerman, Zimmerman . . .

ZIMMERMAN: I was an altar boy in my youth.
Once even got arrested when I was your age, for punching
this white cop who was trying to shake down
my friend.

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TRAYVON: Did you do time?

ZIMMERMAN: My father was the reason.

TRAYVON: The reason?

ZIMMERMAN: The reason I got off: Judge Zimmerman.

TRAYVON: Zimmerman, Zimmerman,

Zimmerman, Judge Zimmerman . . .

Zimmerman, Zimmerman,

that's not why you're here now.

ZIMMERMAN: I had a girl I just could not let go.

Came to her house when she called.

When she pushed me I pushed her back harder.

TRAYVON: Zimmerman, Zimmerman,

Zimmerman, Zimmerman . . .

I'm scared of you.

ZIMMERMAN: That's funny. I'm afraid of people like you.

TRAYVON: If you're so afraid then why am I the one who has to run away?

ZIMMERMAN: Because I've got the gun,

because I've got the gun.

One of us is going to die tonight

because I've got the gun.

TRAYVON: Because you've got the gun,

because you've got the gun.

One of us is going to die tonight

because you've got the gun.

ZIMMERMAN: If you carried a gun legally like me, you'd be safe right now.

If you carried guns like this one.

Kel-Tec .9 mm subcompact.

Easy to hide in your underwear.

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Not much fun to shoot.
Only a few feet away and I'd miss you.
But when you're on top of me
pounding my head against the stone, I bet my gun's
going to set me free.

TRAYVON: Because you've got the gun,
because you've got the gun.
One of us is going to die tonight
because you've got the gun.
But why you hate me, son?
We should be together on this.
We're both middle-class.

ZIMMERMAN: You live here?

TRAYVON: I'm visiting.

ZIMMERMAN: No, I'm nothing like you!
A hood. Drooping pants.
Been expelled five times in one year.
Jewelry in the bag at school.
Where's your mother? Where's your father?
Where's your God damned respect?
Why you smoking dope and bragging about it?
Why the golden teeth?
[TRAYVON is shot.]
Why can't you try just a bit harder to be me?

TRAYVON: Zimmerman. A wannabe white man!

ZIMMERMAN: Zimmerman, Zimmerman,
Zimmerman, Zimmerman . . .

TRAYVON: Zimmerman, Zimmerman,

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Zimmerman, Zimmerman . . .

ZIMMERMAN: Because I've got the gun. . .

TRAYVON: Now is when I run at him. . .

ZIMMERMAN: Because I've got the gun. . .

TRAYVON: And pop his nose like a balloon . . .

ZIMMERMAN: One of us is going to die tonight. . .

TRAYVON: A punching and a kicking .

ZIMMERMAN: Because I've got the gun .

TRAYVON: Help! Help!

ZIMMERMAN: Because I've got the gun . . .

TRAYVON: Help! Help! S***! . . .

ZIMMERMAN: One of us is going to die tonight . . .

TRAYVON: Help! Help! Help! Help!

ZIMMERMAN: Because I've got the gun . . .

TRAYVON. Help! Help! Help!

ZIMMERMAN: Because I've got the gun . . .

TRAYVON: Help! Help!

ZIMMERMAN: Because I've got the gun . . .

TRAYVON: Help! Help!

ZIMMERMAN: One of us is going to die tonight. . .

TRAYVON: Help . . . !

ZIMMERMAN: Because I've got the gun . . .

*******scene********

The OFFICER arrives. She carries Zimmerman's gun. The Officer's song at the end reveals that we've been in George Zimmerman's head all along. For the literal-minded, perhaps Zimmerman is getting his gun back at the courthouse.

OFFICER: Zimmerman. Zimmerman, you're free.

You're free to go. Your house arrest is over.

A jury of women ruled you did your best.

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It's a crazy old mixed-up world.

Hello? Hello? Zimmerman, you seem distracted.

Give us the bracelet from round your ankle, and we'll give you back this gun.

The Equalizer. This Kel-Tec . 9 mm subcompact.

Easy to hide in your underwear.

Not much fun to shoot. Only a few feet away and I'd miss you.

But when you're on top of me

pounding my head against the stone, I bet this gun would set me free .

But Zimmerman, poor innocent Zimmerman . . .

These a**holes always get away.

Not this time. Not this time, right Zimmerman?

SOURCE INFORMATION

Author: Dan O'Brien with music by Quetzal Flores
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AWARD HISTORY

2024 National Qualifier

To assist with music/rhythms in this selection, a performance can be viewed at
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Cn2Rjyf479Q

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